Neal T. Gillespie

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Hiring Committee
McKinney Public Library
City of McKinney
401 E. Virginia Street, McKinney, TX 75069

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am applying for the Library Technician position in Community Engagement with the McKinney Public Library. The part of this job that drew me is the programming and outreach, which is closer to what I actually do all day than the title might suggest.

My current work is running campaigns from concept to delivery. I plan them, coordinate the vendors and partners who produce them, hold the schedule together across several concurrent projects, produce the promotional material, and then report on whether any of it worked. Translate that from fundraising into library programming and it is substantially the same job: design something, line up the people who make it happen, get the word out, run the event, and find out afterward whether it was worth repeating.

I have also done the public-facing library-adjacent side. At the University of Austin I was the on-site point of contact for visitor tours of the campus library, hosting guests and answering their questions, and I coordinated donor events with internal departments and outside partners. Earlier I staffed a public service desk at Chapman University's law school, so the circulation and reference side of the role is familiar ground.

One thing I would bring that is less common in this kind of role is measurement. I built StateTrack, a public database of campaign finance records covering all fifty states, and the catalog behind an archive at work. Evaluating current program and outreach models is listed in your duties, and I am comfortable doing that with real numbers rather than impressions.

I am working toward this as a career. I have begun the ALA's Library Support Staff Certification, start a Library and Information Services certificate in the spring, and hold a valid California driver's license. I should say plainly that I am able to relocate. I am in Austin now, and I am willing to move anywhere in Texas a position requires. Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Neal T. Gillespie